

Prisoners of Air



1850. The Franklin expedition is missing.

Two explorers form an unlikely friendship as they search the Arctic for its traces. But can their new bond survive a terrible discovery that will shake their faith in empire to its core?

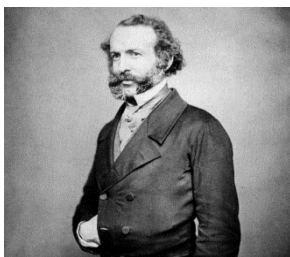
The History



In 1845, Britain sent two ships north to chart the Northwest Passage. Above are pictures taken of the officers before they set sail. Their disappearance is one of history's greatest mysteries.

It represented a massive shock to British self-confidence. Over the next 35 years, countless rescue expeditions were launched and found only eerie traces lost amidst the ice.

Meet our Explorers



John Rae (1813-1893) was a tough, brilliant explorer with a respect for Inuit culture that was far ahead of its time. After interviewing the Inuit, he found evidence that the Franklin men had resorted to cannibalism.

For daring to trust native testimony, and question British supremacy, his career was destroyed and his name wiped from history. Until now.



Robert Goodsir (1823-1895) was a talented doctor and the brother of Harry, an assistant surgeon on the Franklin expedition.

Wracked by grief, Robert sailed on several missions in search of his brother, despite a lack of Arctic experience.

He saw Rae's theories as an insult to both Britain and his brother's memory.

This film tells the story of these two men. And imagines what would happen had they met...

Rooted in British history and inspired by Inuit myth, *Prisoners of Air* is the story of an unlikely friendship formed at the end of the world. And of a mystery that may have been better left unsolved.

By combining survival horror with the buddy movie, it depicts both the absurdity and beauty of male friendship, and explores how that friendship is tested when the two men discover a single Franklin survivor...

A lovechild of Robert Eggers' *The Lighthouse* and AMC's *The Terror*, *Prisoners* takes us two hundred years into the past, into a world where the Arctic was as inhospitable as an alien planet and Britain was a superpower assured of its superiority.

Against this backdrop, Rae is a dissident who considers Britain's greatness a sham whilst Goodsir is a true believer. Forced together by circumstance, with Rae acting as both a literal and spiritual guide, Goodsir is slowly confronted with a dark and unspeakable truth; that the Franklin men stooped to shocking savagery and the Arctic is where greatness goes to die.

In the harshest place on earth, Goodsir must learn that loyalty to a friend means more than loyalty to his nation.

